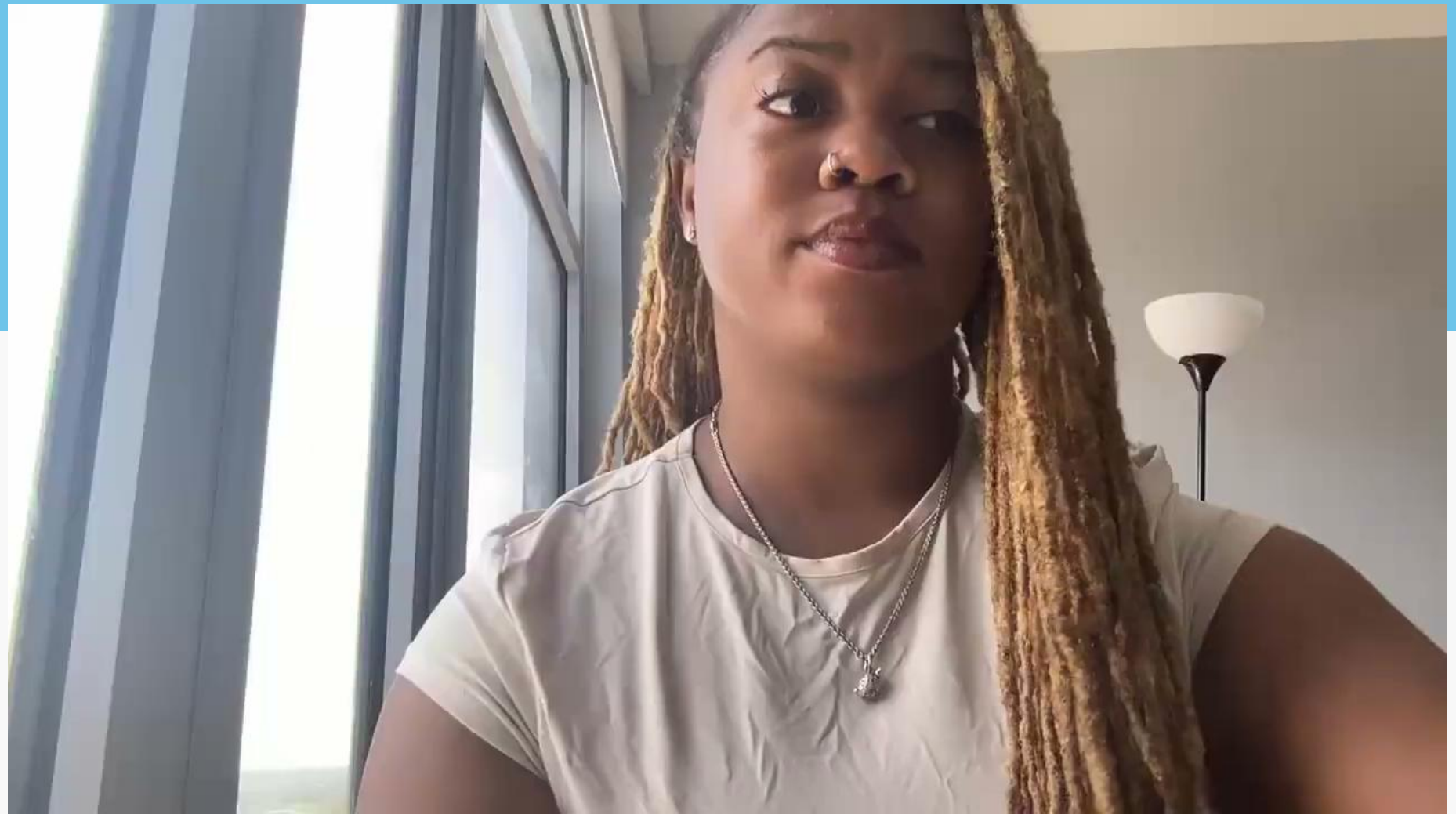
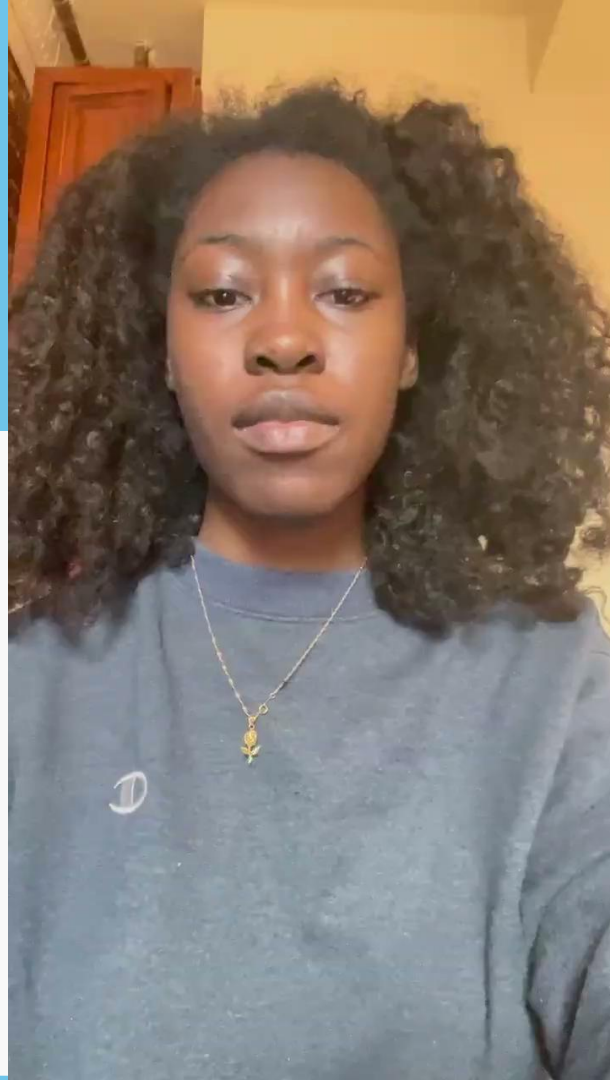








Prepared by the Food Insecurity Capstone

The Student Nutrition and Access Reform Act

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Introduction

Our capstone, addresses the intersection of food insecurity and student health, both physical and mental, through direct engagement and political advocacy. Through nutritional educational outreach and policy engagement, we challenge structural barriers by advocating for meaningful reforms to federal nutrition programs like SNAP and key legislation such as the Farm Bill.

Background

The U.S. Farm Bill and Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) provide food assistance, however...

- Current SNAP policies fail to meet the needs of:
 - College Students
 - Low-income individuals
 - Residents in **Food Deserts**: Places where people lack convenient access to affordable and healthy food
- Nearly **39%** of college students experienced Food Insecurity
- Only **18%** of potentially eligible students enrolled in SNAP receive benefits
 - Due to **confusing rules, outdated income requirements and strict work hour mandates**



Project Goals

1. To improve nutritional literacy in collegiate students to combat food-borne health conditions and illnesses and understand how nutrition can impact mental health
 2. Advocate for SNAP reform to accurately reflect the needs and conditions of college student
 3. Address Food Deserts by promoting strategic partnerships with local food vendors and increasing federal and local funding
 4. Advocate for policy change in the Farm Bill
-

The Culinary Curriculum

In March, students within the AUC were given the opportunity to learn how to utilize common pantry staples to create a healthy and tasty meal.

Led by Capstone team lead, Margaret Harris, and a professional nutritionist, students made chilli with their choices of spices and three-ingredient sweet potato biscuits.

Not only were students given the knowledge to properly nourish themselves, but the event provided a space for community bonding and fun.

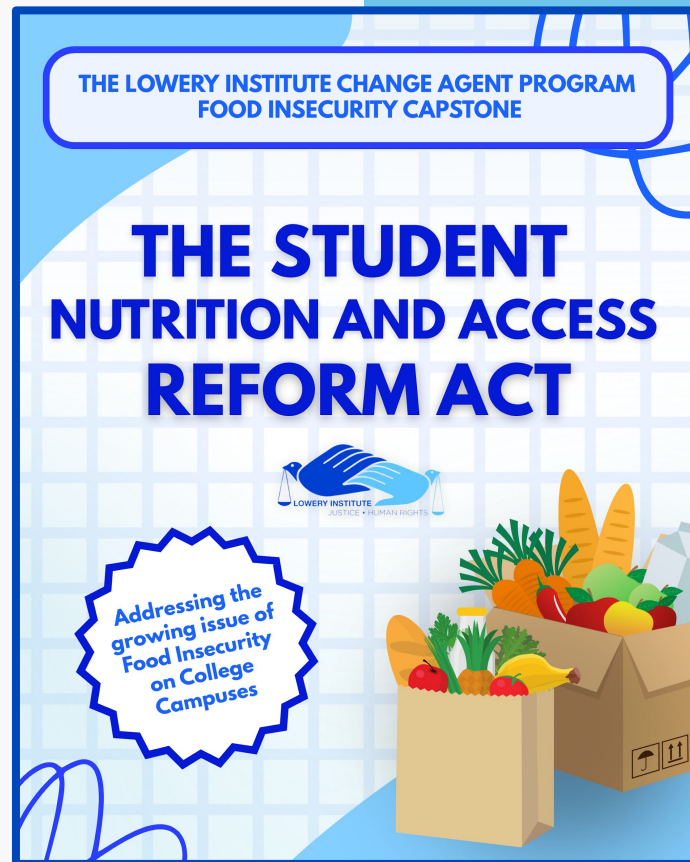


Legislative Proposal

With SNAP's restrictive eligibility requirements, we seek to to make these benefits more accessible to the most vulnerable.

This looks like:

1. **Eliminate Work Hour Requirements for Students** – Allow college students to qualify for SNAP based on income and financial need alone, rather than requiring them to meet strict work requirements.
2. **Adjust Income Limits Based on Regional Cost of Living** – Update SNAP eligibility criteria to reflect the true cost of living in different areas, ensuring that more low-income individuals can receive assistance.
3. **Expand Eligibility for Students** – Broaden the definition of "eligible students" to include those who are financially independent or come from low-income families, making it easier for them to access food assistance.
4. **Increase SNAP Support for Students in Food Deserts** – Implement policies that help students in food deserts by expanding partnerships with local farmers' markets, grocery stores, and delivery services that accept SNAP benefits.



Sustainability and Future Plans



Enhanced Pantry Awareness

Educational Programming

Food Literacy

Creative Engagement

Conclusion

Our legislative proposal aims to address the growing issue of Food Insecurity on college campuses by advocating for meaningful reforms in federal nutritional assistance programs, such 'SNAP' and key legislation like the 'Farm Bill'.

Thank you

